Contact Center - Omnichannel: Configure Routing Using *Flows*, Rule Sets, and *Flow* Assignments

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Article Information

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Product: Contact Center

Related Articles

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- Contact Center -- Flow Studio: Overview
- Contact Center Creating a Flow: Start a new Flow design
- Contact Center Flow Studio Interface - Flow Menu
- Contact Center Flow Studio - Adding a Page

Inbound email, SMS, and WhatsApp messages can be routed using either Rule Sets or Flows. For each source (email address or messaging number), only one routing method can be active at a time.

Refer to Omnichannel: Overview & FAQ for product description and a list of commonly asked questions.

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Before You Begin

- You must be able to sign in to the Contact Center admin portal and access Omnichannels configuration.
- Flows are created in Flow Studio. Rule Sets are created in their respective Omnichannel tiles.

▶ Flow Source Assignments

▶ Flow Groups

▶ Route Inbound Voice Using Voice Email Flows

▶ Route Inbound Email Using Email Rule Sets

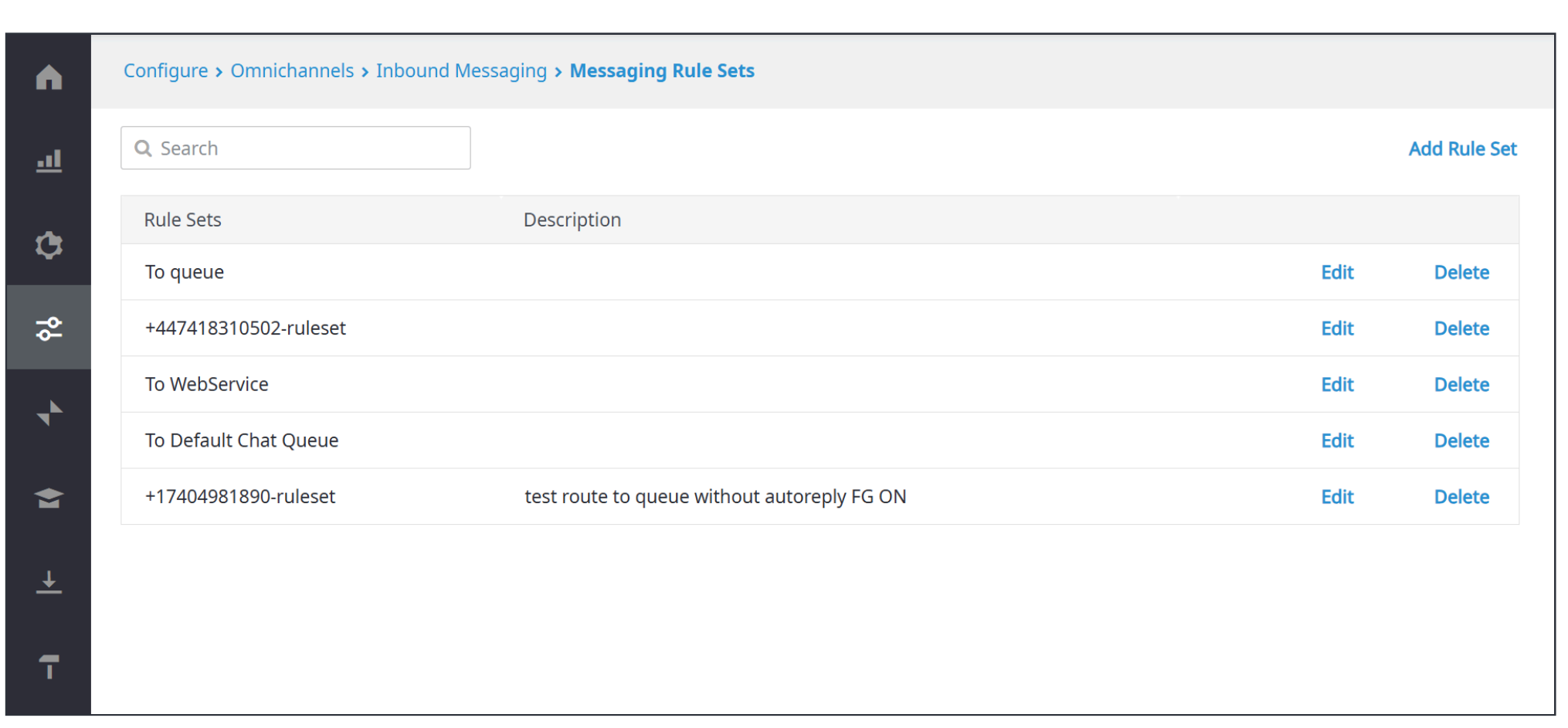
▶ Route Inbound Email Using Email Flows

▼ Route Inbound Messaging Using Messaging Rule Sets

Messaging Rule Sets provide simple, rules-based routing for inbound SMS and WhatsApp messages. Rules are evaluated when a new messaging session is created and typically route the conversation directly to a queue.

Accessing Messaging Rule Sets

1. Log on to the Contact Center admin portal, and then navigate to *Configure > Omnichannels*.
2. Navigate to *Inbound Messaging > Messaging Rule Sets*.



Configure › Omnichannels › Inbound Messaging › Messaging Rule Sets
Search
Add Rule Set

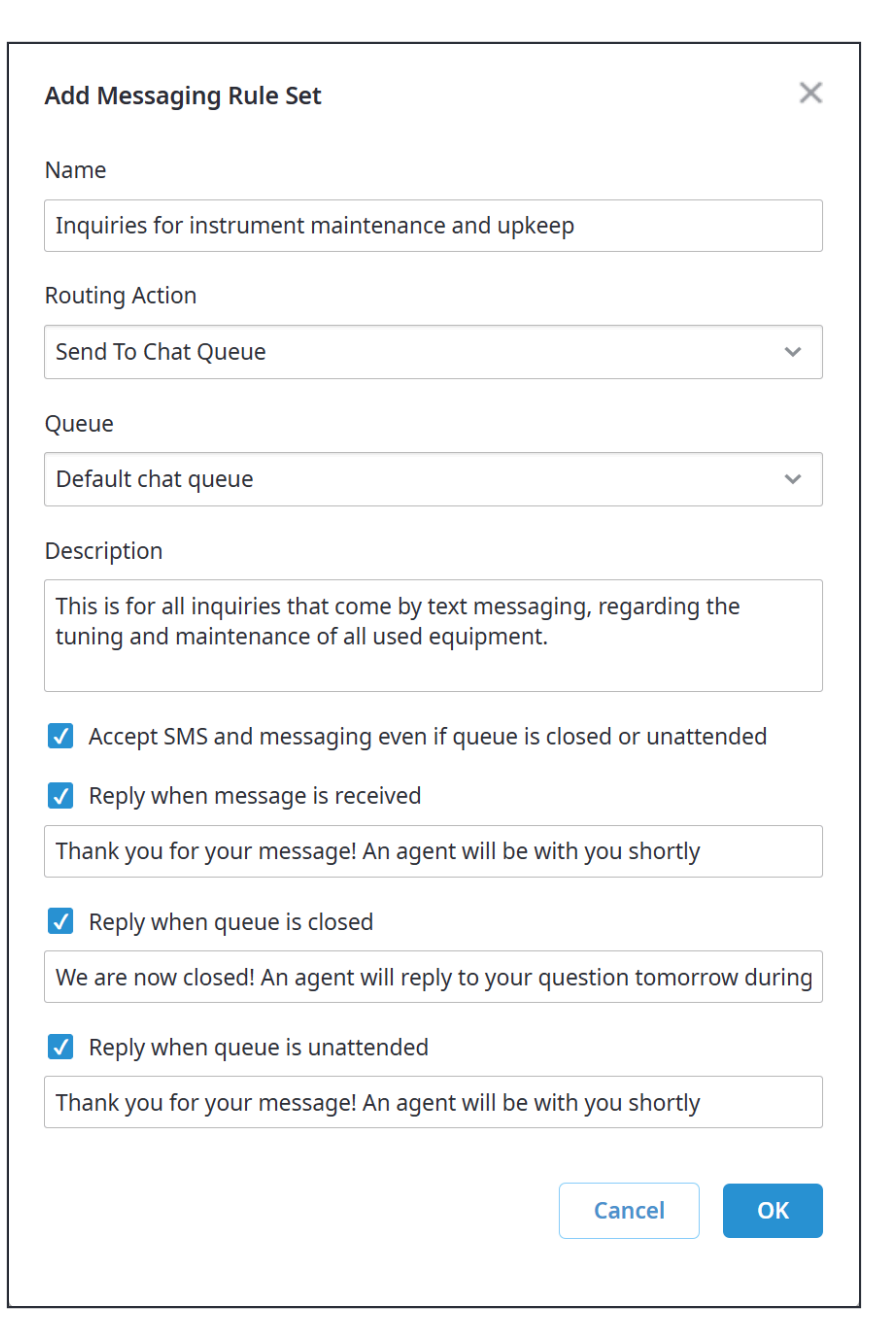
Rule Sets	Description		
To queue		Edit	Delete
+447418310502-ruleset		Edit	Delete
To WebService		Edit	Delete
To Default Chat Queue		Edit	Delete
+17404981890-ruleset	test route to queue without autoreply FG ON	Edit	Delete

This page defines how incoming SMS and WhatsApp messages are routed, queued, and automatically responded to. Use this page to create, edit, or delete the rule sets that control where messages go and how the system responds.

Column	Description
Rule Sets	The name of the rule set.
Description	A brief explanation of the purpose of the rule set.
Edit	Click to edit the rule set.
Delete	Click to delete the rule set.

Creating Messaging Rule Sets

1. From the Messaging Rule Sets page, click **Add Rule Set**.
2. Configure the rule set settings, and then click **OK** to save.
3. Repeat step 1 to create additional rule sets as needed.



Add Messaging Rule Set

Name: Inquiries for instrument maintenance and upkeep

Routing Action: Send To Chat Queue

Queue: Default chat queue

Description: This is for all inquiries that come by text messaging, regarding the tuning and maintenance of all used equipment.

☑ Accept SMS and messaging even if queue is closed or unattended

☑ Reply when message is received

Thank you for your message! An agent will be with you shortly

☑ Reply when queue is closed

We are now closed! An agent will reply to your question tomorrow during

☑ Reply when queue is unattended

Thank you for your message! An agent will be with you shortly

When creating a rule set:

Setting	Description
Name	Enter a clear, descriptive name for the rule set.
Routing Action	Select how messages handled by this rule set should be routed. Available options include sending messages to a chat queue, routing to email, or routing to a web service.
Queue	If the routing action requires a queue, choose the destination queue where messages will be delivered.
(Optional) Description	Add a description to explain the purpose of this rule set or any special behavior it supports.
Accept SMS And Messaging Even If Queue Is Closed Or Unattended	Select the checkmark if messages should be accepted even when the queue is closed or unattended.
Configure Auto-Reply Messages	Define automated replies that can be sent when: • A message is received • The queue is closed • The queue is unattended These replies help keep customers informed about what to expect.

▼ Route Inbound Messaging Using Messaging Flows

Messaging Flows use Flow Studio to control how SMS and WhatsApp conversations are handled. Messaging Flows execute at the start of a conversation session.

Once a Messaging Flow routes the conversation to a queue using the Wait for Agent business function, flow execution ends. The flow does not continue while the user waits or while an agent is handling the conversation.

Messaging Flow Lifecycle And Sessions

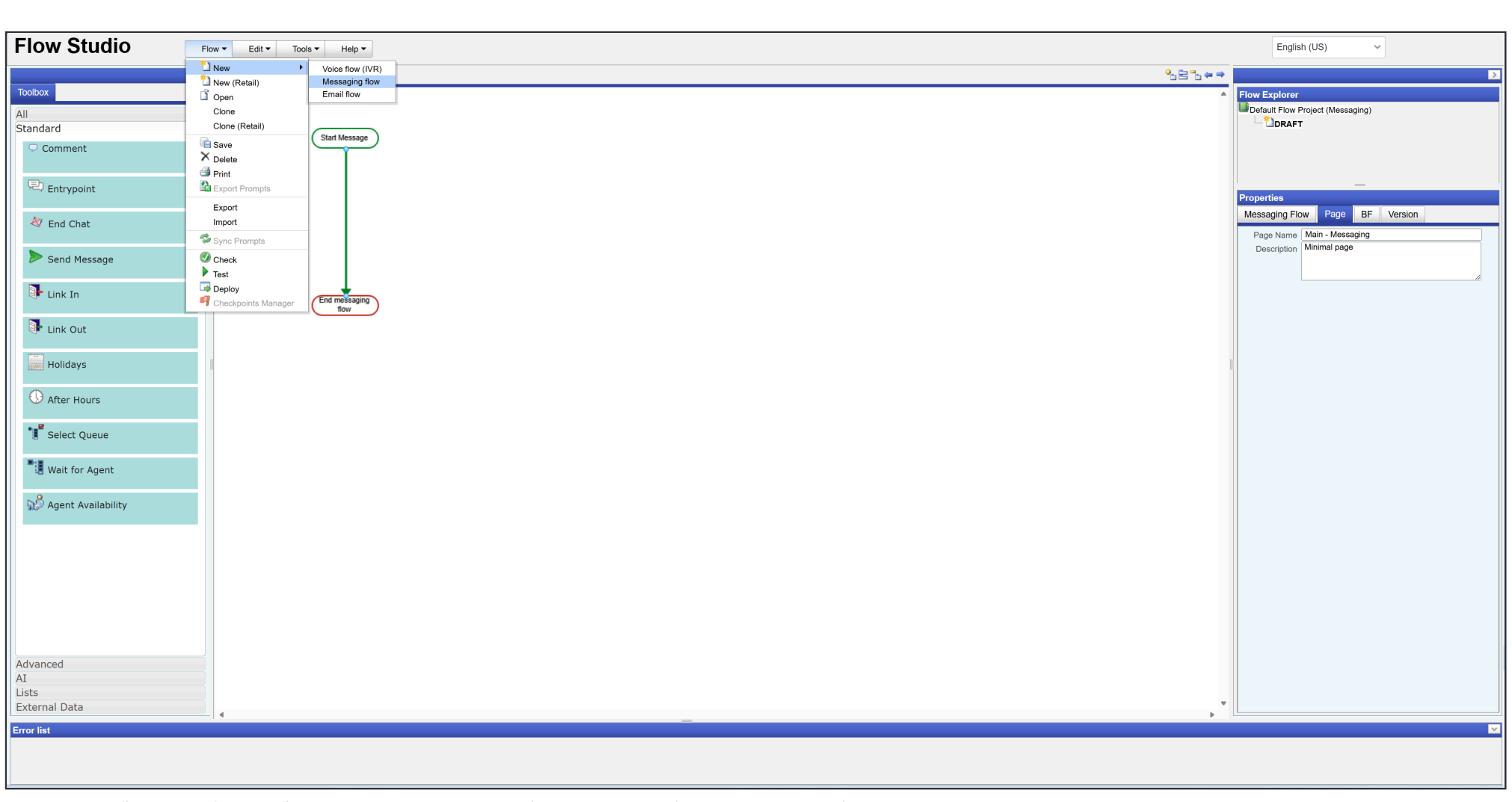
SMS and WhatsApp interactions are session-based. A session represents a continuous conversation between a customer and the call center.

The flow executes at session start. Subsequent messages during the same session do not re-trigger the flow unless the session has ended.

The behavior is different from Voice and Email flows due to the session-based nature of messaging, where conversations are ongoing and messages arrive asynchronously and without a fixed start/end.

Accessing Messaging Flows

1. Open Flow Studio (*Contact Center > Configure > Omnichannels > Flow Studio*), and then navigate to *Configure > Omnichannels > Flow Studio*.
2. Navigate to *Flow > New > Messaging flow*.



The business functions that appear in the Business Function panel are all the ones that can be used to create a messaging flow.

Business Functions Used By Messaging Flows

Specific to Messaging Flows

Business Function	Description
Start Message	Defines the entry point for inbound SMS and WhatsApp interactions. Triggers the flow when a new messaging session is created. Only one Start Message is supported per flow.
Send Message	Sends a single outbound SMS or WhatsApp message to the user.
Timeout Handling (Inactivity)	Messaging sessions are subject to inactivity timeouts controlled by the backend. Timeouts are not configurable in Flow Studio and may result in silent session expiration.
End Message	Explicitly ends the messaging interaction. Any subsequent inbound message starts a new interaction.

Can also be used for Messaging Flows

Business Function	Description
Set Variable	Stores values related to the messaging session. Uses chatSessionId for session tracking.
Conditional / Conditional Range	Used to branch flow logic based on variables, intent confidence, or external data.
Search External Data	Retrieves external information such as CRM data for use during flow execution.
Select Queue	Selects the destination messaging queue.
Rule-Based Transfer	Supported with limitations. DID-based routing is not supported for messaging.
Bulletins	Not supported in MVP for SMS and WhatsApp.
After Hours	Controls how inbound messages are handled outside of defined business hours.
Agent Availability	Controls how inbound messages are handled when agents are not available or logged into a queue.
Holidays	Controls how inbound messages are handled on holidays
REST WSCall	Calls REST APIs during a flow.
Wait for Agent	Places the conversation into a messaging queue and ends flow execution. No messages are sent while waiting. queue priority and optional metadata may be set.
Intent Capture	uses AI to understand the user's intent based on one or more inbound messages. Messages are collected within a short time window to support natural typing behavior. Flow routing is based on intent match, low confidence, or error outcomes.

Note: messaging sessions are subject to backend-controlled inactivity timeouts. Timeout behavior is not configurable in Flow Studio.

▼ FAQ

Email Flows and Rule Sets FAQ

Q: What determines how emails are placed into queues?

A: Email routing supports Last Agent Email Routing (LAER) when emails are placed into queue. This is a global configuration not controlled within Flow Studio.

Q: How is dequeuing handled?

A: Dequeuing follows existing email queue behavior and is managed outside Flow Studio. Refer to Configuring Email Queues and Managing Email Queues.

Important: email flows do not change how agents receive or respond to emails. Post-queue and post-queue agent automation is not supported.

Q: Are existing email routing rules automatically migrated to Email Rule Sets?

A: Yes. Existing email routing settings from the legacy Email Routing page are automatically migrated into Email Rule Sets. No action is required to continue using these settings.

Q: Are existing email routing rules automatically migrated to Email Flows?

A: No. Migration applies only to Email Rule Sets. Email addresses must be manually assigned to Email Flows using Flow Source Assignment if adoption of Email Flows is desired.

Q: Can I mix Email Rule Sets and Email Flows?

A: Yes. An email address can be routed using either Email Rule Sets or Email Flows, based on administrator configuration. A single email address cannot route to both Rule Sets and Flows, but an account may utilize both with different email addresses.

Q: Does this change how agents receive or respond to emails?

A: No. Agent handling of emails remains unchanged.

Messaging Flows and Rule Sets FAQ

Q: How are timeouts, inactivity, and dequeuing handled?

A: Messaging sessions are subject to backend-controlled timeouts. These include inactivity timeouts while waiting for an agent and general session expiration. Timeout behavior is not configurable in Flow Studio. Dequeuing behavior is handled outside of Flow Studio by the backend and queue configuration. Flows do not control dequeue logic. Refer to General Queue Information and Manage SMS.

Q: Are existing SMS and WhatsApp routing settings automatically migrated to Messaging Flows?

A: No. Existing messaging routing remains in place. Messaging numbers must be manually assigned to Messaging Flows if adoption is desired.

Q: Can I mix Messaging Rule Sets and Messaging Flows?

A: Yes. A messaging number can be routed using either Messaging Rule Sets or Messaging Flows, based on administrator configuration.

Q: Does this change how agents handle SMS or WhatsApp conversations?

A: No. Agent handling of messaging conversations remains unchanged.

Is this answer helpful?

Yes No

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